development of new chemical and pharmaceutical products are notable examples of a high-tech industry.

10. Manufacturing sector is considered to be the backbone of development in general and economic development in particular mainly because-
    - Manufacturing industries not only help in modernising agriculture, which forms the backbone of our economy, they also reduce the heavy dependence of people on agricultural income by providing them jobs in secondary and tertiary sectors.
    - Industrial development is a precondition for eradication of unemployment and poverty from our country. This was the main Philosophy behind public sector industries and joint sector ventures in India. It was also aimed at bringing down regional disparities by establishing industries in tribal and backward areas.
11. Over the last two decades, the share of manufacturing sector has stagnated at 17% of GDP - out of a total of 27% for the industry which includes 10% for mining, quarrying, electricity and gas. This is much lower in comparison to some East Asian economies, where it is 25 to 35%. The trend of growth rate in manufacturing over the last decade has been around 7% per annum.

    The desired growth rate over the next decade is 12%. Since 2003, manufacturing is once again growing at the rate of 9 to 10% per annum. With appropriate policy interventions by the government and renewed efforts by the industry to improve productivity, economists predict that manufacturing can achieve its target over the next decade. The National Manufacturing Competitiveness Council (NMCC) has been set up with this objective.
12. In ancient India, cotton textiles were produced with hand spinning and handloom weaving techniques. After the 18^{th} century, power-looms came into use. Our traditional industries suffered a setback during the colonial period because they could not compete with the mill-made cloth from England.

    In the early years, the cotton textile Industry was concentrated in the cotton growing belt of Maharashtra and Gujarat. Availability of raw cotton, market, transport including accessible port facilities,